

MIDI Field Guide MacBook + MIDI Fighter Twister + Feather M4

This guide describes the simplest setup for recording MIDI traffic into .mid files while simultaneously forwarding the MIDI traffic to a Feather M4 microcontroller.

System Topology

MIDI Fighter Twister → MacBook Pro → Feather M4 / Microcontroller

The MacBook acts as a MIDI “tee”: Records MIDI into a .mid file Simultaneously forwards the MIDI traffic to the microcontroller

What To Bring

- MacBook Pro
- MacBook power adapter
- USB cable for MIDI Fighter Twister
- USB cable for Feather M4 / microcontroller
- USB hub or USB adapters if needed
- Optional: headphones or small speaker for MIDI playback checks

Before Leaving Home

1. Launch Aria Maestosa and confirm it opens correctly.
2. Enable the IAC Driver on macOS:
 - 1 Open Applications → Utilities → Audio MIDI Setup
 - 2 Choose Window → Show MIDI Studio
 - 3 Double-click IAC Driver
 - 4 Check 'Device is online'
 - 5 Ensure at least one port exists, usually called Bus 1

At The Device

- 1 Plug the MIDI Fighter Twister into the MacBook
- 2 Plug the Feather M4 / microcontroller into the MacBook
- 3 Wait a few seconds for macOS to enumerate the devices

Confirm MIDI Devices

In Audio MIDI Setup → MIDI Studio you should see devices similar to:
Midi Fighter Twister

IAC Driver
Feather M4 / USB MIDI device

Create MIDI Routing

In MIDI Studio, create the following virtual cable connections:

Midi Fighter Twister → IAC Driver
IAC Driver → Feather M4

Configure Aria Maestosa

- 1 Open Aria Maestosa
- 2 Choose File → New
- 3 Set MIDI Input to IAC Driver / Bus 1
- 4 Set MIDI Output to Feather M4 / USB MIDI device
- 5 Create tracks for the channels you want to record
- 6 Assign channels to tracks (1 through 10, for example)

Recording Procedure

- 1 Click Record in Aria
- 2 Operate the controller during testing
- 3 Click Stop when finished
- 4 Choose File → Save As...
- 5 Save as a Standard MIDI File (.mid)

Recommended File Naming

Example:

2026-05-03_art_piece_test_01.mid

Quick Validation Test

- 1 Record a short 10-second test
- 2 Move one knob or control
- 3 Stop recording
- 4 Verify MIDI data appears in Aria
- 5 Press Play and confirm the microcontroller reacts

Troubleshooting

Problem	Check
Aria records nothing	Confirm MIDI Input is set to IAC Driver / Bus 1
Feather does not respond	Confirm routing from IAC Driver to Feather

Controller not visible	Reconnect controller and verify in Audio MIDI Setup
Feather not visible	Reconnect Feather and confirm firmware exposes USB MIDI

Recommended lightweight tools: Aria Maestosa Audio MIDI Setup (built into macOS) MIDI Monitor by Snoize (optional but very useful)